

Huxtable bread

‘Bread is one of the great simple pleasures in life,’ Wilson says. ‘It unifies all cultures and brings people together to break it. For me, there are not many better smells than fresh bread out of the oven. Warm, just-baked bread with lots of excellent butter is heaven.’

Makes 2 loaves

450 g plain flour
10 g sea salt, plus ½ tbsp extra for dusting
7 g fresh yeast
300 ml warm water
1 tbsp extra virgin olive oil

1. Mix flour and salt together in a large bowl.
2. Whisk yeast and water together, and pour into dry ingredients. Mix together and knead until a smooth ball forms.
3. Place in a bowl dusted with a little flour and cover with plastic wrap, then place in a warm spot for 1 hour, or until doubled in size. This process is called ‘proving’ the dough.
4. Knock back the dough – a process that involves kneading and stretching to remove air bubbles. Form 2 loaves, then place on a tray lined with baking paper. Cover with a tea towel and place in a warm spot to prove (double in size) for a second time.
5. Meanwhile, preheat oven to 220°C (200°C fan-forced). When loaves have ‘proved’, brush them with oil and sprinkle extra salt over the top.
6. Place in the oven to bake for 20 minutes, or until a dark golden crust has formed.